

People were watching and listening on the move long before the iPhone's launch. The world of always-on streaming, accessible anywhere, has a pre-history: magic lanterns, drive-in theaters, and portable radios.

In *Mobile Personalization*, Justin Grandinetti and Charlie Ecenbarger place Netflix, YouTube, Spotify, TikTok, and other corporate claimants in a lineage that includes the build-out of sprawling, invisible infrastructures—undersea cables, server farms, and adtech. These “architectures of mobility,” together with their Silicon Valley underwriters, make seamless, algorithmic streams possible and profitable. The upshot is an evolving regime of mobile personalization, with entertainment for consumers and data-driven monetization for companies.

Mobile Personalization recasts foundational ideas from Raymond Williams, including “flow” and “mobile privatization,” to account for the algorithmic delivery of targeted video and audio to lucrative audiences. As this important new book argues, the mobile streamers have delivered convenience, but also audience fragmentation and behavioral capture.

JUSTIN GRANDINETTI is an Associate Professor who holds a joint appointment with the Department of Communication Studies and the School of Data Science at the University of North Carolina at Charlotte. Justin takes a critical approach to topics at the intersection of mobile media, streaming media, and artificial intelligence.

CHARLES ECENBARGER is an Associate Professor of Communication at Brevard College, where he coordinates the undergraduate and graduate programs in communication. His research examines mobile media, digital culture, and the role of emerging technologies in shaping everyday life.

MEDIA MANIFOLD SERIES

mediastudies.press

414 W. Broad St. | Bethlehem, PA 18018

www.mediastudies.press

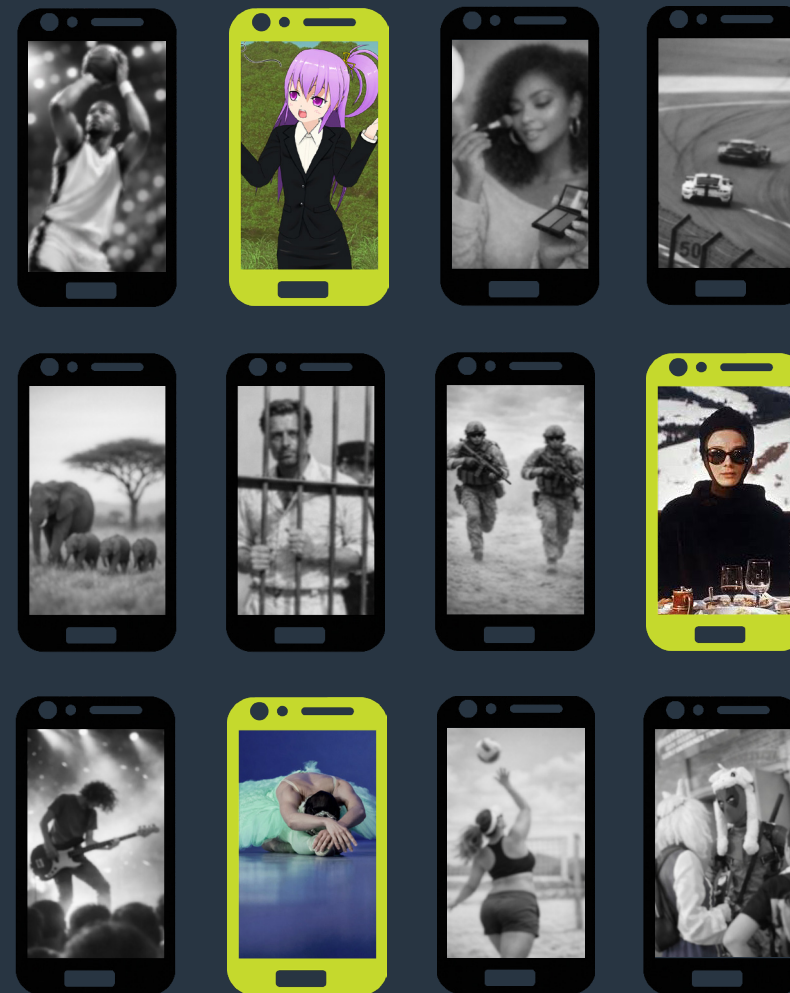
GRANDINETTI & ECENBARGER

MOBILE PERSONALIZATION

mediastudies.press media manifold series

MOBILE PERSONALIZATION

The history and theory of mobile streaming media



JUSTIN GRANDINETTI
CHARLES ECENBARGER